1 Building software that makes a difference

This chapter covers

- The problems that Behavior-Driven Development addresses
- General principles and origins of Behavior-Driven Development
- Activities and outcomes seen in a Behavior-Driven Development project
- The pros and cons of Behavior-Driven Development

This book is about building and delivering better software. It's about building software that works well and is easy to change and maintain, but more importantly, it's about building software that provides real value to its users. We want to build software well, but we also need to build software that's worth building.

In 2012, the U.S. Air Force decided to ditch a major software project that had already cost over $1 billion USD. The Expeditionary Combat Support System was designed to modernize and streamline supply chain management in order to save billions of dollars and meet new legislative requirements. But after seven years of development, the system had still "not yielded any significant military capability."[1]

[1] Chris Kanaracus, "Air Force scraps massive ERP project after racking up $1 billion in costs," *CIO*, November 14, 2012, http://www.cio.com/article/2390341.